

Block 1 — Personality: Concept · Determinants · Type & Trait Theories

Personality: Concept & Definition

Allport (1937): "Dynamic organisation within the person of psychophysical systems that determine unique adjustments to environment." Two pillars: **Individuality** + **Consistency**. **Character** = moral judgement. **Temperament** = inborn characteristics. Both parts of personality but NOT synonymous.

Determinants of Personality

Formula: Personality = Biological × Psychological × Environmental (multiplicative). **Watson** = extreme environmentalist.

5 Biological: Body build (somatotypes), Attractiveness (Brislin & Lewis, 1968), Homeostasis, Physical defects (Adler's organ inferiority), Health.

5 Psychological: Intellectual, Emotional balance ("mental health insurance"), Catharsis, Self-disclosure, Aspiration/Achievement (delusion of grandeur, superiority complex).

6 Environmental: Social acceptance (isolation → sour-grapes), Social deprivation, Educational, Family (identification/imitation), Ordinal position (firstborn/lastborn/middle), Family size.

Type Theories

Hippocrates/Galen (~5th BC)

Blood→**Sanguine** (cheerful). Phlegm→**Phlegmatic** (apathetic). Black bile→**Melancholic** (sad). Yellow bile→**Choleric** (irritable). Baseless today.

Sheldon (1942) — Somatotypes

Ectomorph (thin→artistic, introverted; cerebrotonic). **Endomorph** (round→relaxed, sociable; viscerotonic). **Mesomorph** (muscular→dominant, energetic; somatotonic). 1–7 scale. Weak methodology (Tylor, 1965).

Jung (1922) & MBTI

4 dimensions: E/I, S/N, T/F, J/P (J-P added by Isabel Myers). **16 personality types**. Jung's task = **Individuation**. **Keirsey temperaments:** Guardian, Rational, Idealist, Artisan.

Type A & Type B (Friedman)

Type A = workaholic, driven (coronary risk). Type B = laid back.

Limitations of Types

Discontinuous, all-or-nothing. "*Types exist in the eye of the beholder whereas traits exist within the people.*"

Trait Theories

Allport (1937, 1961)

Lexical approach (17,953 words, Allport & Odbert, 1936). **Idiographic**.

Cardinal (pervasive; e.g., Gandhi→non-violence), **Central** (~5–10; building blocks),

Secondary (situation-specific).

Proprium = self. Seven propiate functions: (1) Bodily self (2) Self-identity (3) Self-esteem (4) Self-extension (5) Self-image (6) Rational coper (7) Propiate striving.

Functional autonomy: Adult motives independent of original origins. "Means becomes end in itself." Preservative vs Propiate.

Mature personality — 6 attributes: Extended self, Warm interactions (intimacy + compassion), Emotional security, Realistic perception, Self-insight & humour, Unifying philosophy of life.

Study of Values (Allport, 1960; based on Spranger): Theoretical, Economic, Aesthetic, Social, Political, Religious.

Cattell (1950)

Surface vs Source traits (16 source → 16 PF). Source traits = better predictors.

Ergs (10 innate: hunger, sex, gregariousness, etc.) + **Sentiments** (environmental).

MAVA: 1/3 heredity, 2/3 environment. **Specification Equation:** $R = f(S, P)$.

Three data sources: L-data, Q-data, OT-data. **Syntality** = group traits.

Global traits: Introversion-Extraversion, Openness vs Tough-Mindedness, Self-Controlled vs Unrestrained.

Eysenck (1916–1997) — PEN Model

4-level hierarchy: Specific responses → Habits → Traits → Superfactors.

Three superfactors (orthogonal): E (Extraversion), N (Neuroticism), P (Psychoticism).

E via ARAS (introverts higher arousal; Yerkes-Dodson Law). **N via limbic system**. **P via testosterone/MAO**.

EPQ + Lie Scale. **Lemon Drop Test** (Corcoran, 1964): introverts secrete 2× saliva.

High I + High N → anxiety disorders. High E + High N → psychopathic disorders.

Big Five / FFM (OCEAN)

Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism.

Goldberg (1981, lexical) vs McCrae & Costa (1987, questionnaire). **NEO-PI-R:** 240 items, 6 facets.

Mischel (1968): person-situation debate. Stable 3–30 years.

Theoretical perspectives: Interpersonal (Sullivan), Socioanalytic (Hogan=reputation), Evolutionary (Buss), FFT (basic tendencies vs characteristic adaptations).

Guilford (1959, 1988)

7 modalities. **GZTS** (10 bipolar traits). Structure-of-Intellect: 120→180 factors. Three levels: hexic, primary, type.